

An Internship Report
Of
Cybersecurity Job Simulation (Mastercard, hosted on Forage)

Submitted

To

School of Computer Science and Engineering

IILM University, Greater Noida, U.P.

In partial fulfilment of the requirement of degree of

B.Tech (Computer Science and Engineering)



By

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Batch: 2024-2028

CANDIDATE'S DECLARATION

I, ADITYA SHARMA, do hereby declare that the internship report titled “Cybersecurity Job Simulation (Mastercard, hosted on Forage)” has been completed by me to fulfil the requirement for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering. All the references have been quoted and I have not taken as such any material from any other source. I affirm that this report is my own and has not been submitted to any other institute for any degree/diploma requirement, and further I shall be solely responsible for any kind of copyright violation in this regard.

Signature:-

Student Name: ADITYA SHARMA

Roll No.: 2410030343

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I am using this opportunity to express my gratitude to everyone who supported me throughout the simulation programme. I am thankful for their guidance, constructive criticism and friendly advice during this work.

I would like to thank Mastercard and Forage for providing the Cybersecurity Job Simulation and a structured platform to gain practical, hands-on exposure to phishing awareness and security analysis. I am also thankful to my institute, IILM University, Greater Noida, and the faculty of the School of Computer Science and Engineering for their continuous support and encouragement.

I express my gratitude to my parents for their support and blessings.

Signature:-

Student Name: ADITYA SHARMA

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3. INTERNSHIP COMPLETION CERTIFICATE



Inspiring and
empowering
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Aditya internship Cybersecurity Job

Certificate of Completion
September 20th, 2026

Over the period of September 2026, Aditya internship has completed practical tasks in:

Design a phishing email simulation
Interpret phishing simulation results

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Tom Brunskill".

Tom Brunskill
Co-Founder of Forage

Enrolment Verification Code 6aafacea8b93e7892af1b8d8 | User Verification Code 68d273943531e46c2427a4ac | Issued by Forage

4. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

4.1 Introduction

This report presents an account of the Cybersecurity Job Simulation offered by Mastercard on the Forage virtual work-experience platform, completed by Aditya Sharma in September 2026 as part of the requirements of the Bachelor of Technology (Computer Science and Engineering) programme at IILM University, Greater Noida. The simulation is a self-paced, virtual programme in which participants work through practical tasks modelled on the day-to-day work of a corporate cybersecurity team.

The practical tasks completed were: (1) designing a phishing email simulation, and (2) interpreting phishing simulation results. Together these cover both halves of a phishing-awareness exercise: creating a realistic but safe test of employee vigilance, and analysing the outcome to decide what an organisation should do next. On completion, Forage issued a Certificate of Completion dated 20 September 2026.

4.2 Organization Profile

Mastercard is a global technology company in the payments industry, connecting consumers, financial institutions, merchants, governments and businesses worldwide. Because it operates payment networks that handle sensitive financial data, information security and staff security awareness are central to its work.

Forage is an online platform that hosts free, self-paced virtual work-experience programmes, known as job simulations, designed together with leading employers. Participants complete realistic workplace tasks and receive a certificate on completion. The Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation was hosted on Forage, and the certificate for it was issued by Forage and signed by Tom Brunskill, Co-Founder of Forage.

4.3 Problem Statement

Phishing remains one of the most common ways in which attackers gain an initial foothold in an organisation, because it targets people rather than software. Technical controls such as spam filters reduce the volume of malicious email but cannot stop every message, so organisations also run simulated phishing exercises to measure how staff respond and to guide awareness training.

Engineering students usually meet social engineering and phishing only as theory: definitions, categories and examples. Far fewer get to practise designing an awareness

exercise or reading its results to decide what should be done. The problem addressed by this simulation was to practise that end-to-end skill: to design a phishing email simulation, and then to interpret the results of a phishing simulation and turn them into meaningful findings.

4.4 Project Objectives

- To understand how phishing and other social-engineering attacks work and which indicators make an email convincing or suspicious.
- To design a phishing email simulation intended to test and improve employee security awareness.
- To interpret phishing simulation results and identify what they say about user behaviour.
- To translate findings into practical recommendations for reducing phishing risk.
- To complete all practical tasks and earn the Certificate of Completion.

4.5 Scope of the Project

The scope of this simulation covers two practical tasks: the design of a phishing email simulation, and the interpretation of phishing simulation results. It was a virtual, self-paced learning exercise carried out on the Forage platform. It did not involve any live organisational system, and no real employees or third parties were sent simulated phishing messages. The certificate covers the two tasks listed on it and does not represent employment at, or a placement with, the sponsoring company.

4.6 Technologies and Tools Used

- **Learning platform:** Forage virtual job-simulation platform (Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation).
- **Security concepts:** phishing and social engineering, spoofed or look-alike senders, manufactured urgency, suspicious links and attachments, and other common phishing indicators.
- **Phishing simulation:** planning a simulated phishing email, its target audience, and its learning objective.
- **Result analysis:** reading simulation metrics such as how many recipients opened, clicked or reported a message, and comparing behaviour across groups.

- **Documentation:** written deliverables prepared and submitted as part of each task.

4.7 System Architecture

A phishing simulation programme can be understood as a lifecycle of connected stages. The layers below summarise the general workflow covered by the two tasks of this simulation.

- **Threat Layer:** understanding how attackers use phishing and who within an organisation is most likely to be targeted.
- **Design Layer:** planning a simulated phishing email, including its scenario, sender, subject, message and the indicators a careful reader should notice.
- **Delivery Layer:** sending the simulation in a controlled way to an authorised audience (considered conceptually in this virtual simulation).
- **Measurement Layer:** collecting results such as opens, clicks and reports.
- **Analysis Layer:** interpreting the results to identify patterns, risky behaviours and groups needing support.
- **Response Layer:** turning the findings into recommendations, such as targeted training and clearer reporting guidance.

4.8 Methodology

The simulation followed a task-based methodology in which each task presented a realistic workplace scenario, as summarised below.

Task	Module	Description
1	Design a phishing email simulation	Planning and designing a simulated phishing email that tests employee awareness in a safe, controlled way, with a clear learning objective.
2	Interpret phishing simulation results	Analysing the outcome of a phishing simulation, identifying what the results reveal about staff behaviour, and drawing conclusions and recommendations.
Final	Certificate of Completion	Issued by Forage on 20 September 2026 on completion of the practical tasks.

Note: The simulation was self-paced and completed in September 2026. There was no stipend associated with it, and completion was recognised through a Certificate of

Completion rather than a graded assessment.

4.9 Expected Outcomes

- Ability to explain how phishing attacks work and to recognise their common indicators.
- Ability to design a realistic but safe phishing simulation with a clear awareness objective.
- Ability to read phishing simulation results and identify risky behaviours and at-risk groups.
- Ability to recommend practical actions, such as training and reporting improvements, based on simulation findings.
- A completed set of practical tasks and a Certificate of Completion issued by Forage.

4.10 Certificates of Completion and Communication Proof

The Certificate of Completion for the Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation, issued by Forage, is attached in Chapter 3 of this report. Its verification details are given below.

Certificate	Cybersecurity Job Simulation - Certificate of Completion
Issued by	Forage
Date of issue	20 September 2026
Tasks completed	Design a phishing email simulation; Interpret phishing simulation results
Enrolment Verification Code	6aafacea8b93e7892af1b8d8
User Verification Code	68d273943531e46c2427a4ac

5. BIBLIOGRAPHY/REFERENCES

1. Forage, “Cybersecurity Job Simulation – Certificate of Completion,” Enrolment Verification Code 6aafacea8b93e7892af1b8d8, User Verification Code 68d273943531e46c2427a4ac, 20 September 2026.
2. Forage, virtual work-experience programmes (job simulations), <https://www.theforage.com/>
3. Mastercard, <https://www.mastercard.com/>
4. Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA), guidance on phishing and social engineering, <https://www.cisa.gov/>